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United States Patent	12404582
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
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Method and apparatus for embedding ruthenium in recess formed on substrate surface

Abstract

A method for embedding ruthenium in a recess formed on a surface of a substrate includes: forming a ruthenium layer in a region including a bottom portion of the recess by supplying a gas including, as a ruthenium precursor, a ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms to the substrate having a metal exposed on a bottom surface of the recess; and subsequently embedding ruthenium in the recess so as to cover the ruthenium layer by supplying a gas including, as a ruthenium precursor, Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 to the substrate.

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Appl. No.:	18/292262
Filed (or PCT Filed):	July 15, 2022
PCT No.:	PCT/JP2022/027910
PCT Pub. No.:	WO2023/008239
PCT Pub. Date:	February 02, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240360547 A1	Oct. 31, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP 2021-122649 Jul. 27, 2021

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: C23C16/04 (20060101); C23C16/16 (20060101); C23C16/458 (20060101); C23C16/52 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC C23C16/045 (20130101); C23C16/16 (20130101); C23C16/458 (20130101); C23C16/52 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: C23C (16/045); C23C (16/16); C23C (16/458); C23C (16/52); C23C (16/18); C23C (16/4481); C23C (16/06); C23C (16/54); H01L (21/283); H01L (21/285); H01L (21/28556); H01L (21/28562); H01L (21/76843); H01L (21/76877); H01L (21/67184); H01L (21/67207)

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Background/Summary

(1) This is a National Phase Application filed under 35 U.S.C. 371 as a national stage of PCT/JP2022/027910, filed Jul. 15, 2022, an application claiming the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-122649, filed Jul. 27, 2021, the content of each of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present disclosure relates to a method and an apparatus for embedding ruthenium in a recess formed on a substrate surface.

BACKGROUND

(3) In a manufacturing process of semiconductor devices, there are cases where a metal film is formed on a semiconductor wafer, which serves as a substrate for manufacturing semiconductor devices, and the metal film is a ruthenium film. In Patent Documents 1 and 2, a process of embedding ruthenium in a recess formed on the wafer is disclosed.

PRIOR ART DOCUMENTS

Patent Documents

(4) Patent Document 1: Japanese Laid-open Publication No. 2018-147949 Patent Document 2: Japanese Laid-open Publication No. 2020-047864

(5) The present disclosure provides a technique capable of implementing embedding of ruthenium in a recess formed on a substrate surface while preventing an increase in resistance.

SUMMARY

(6) According to one embodiment of the present disclosure, a method for embedding ruthenium in a recess formed on a surface of a substrate includes: forming a ruthenium layer in a region including a bottom portion of the recess by supplying a gas including, as a ruthenium precursor, a ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms to the substrate having a metal exposed on a bottom surface of the recess; and subsequently embedding ruthenium in the recess so as to cover the ruthenium layer by supplying a gas including, as a ruthenium precursor, Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 to the substrate.

(7) According to the present disclosure, it is possible to implement embedding of ruthenium into a recess formed on a substrate surface while preventing an increase in resistance.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic plan view illustrating one embodiment of an apparatus for embedding ruthenium according to the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is a longitudinal cross-sectional view illustrating an example of a first film formation processor provided in the above apparatus.

(3) FIG. 3 is a longitudinal cross-sectional view illustrating an example of a second film formation processor provided in the above apparatus.

(4) FIG. 4A is a first longitudinal cross-sectional view of a wafer surface related to a first embodiment step of a method for embedding ruthenium according to the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4B is a second longitudinal cross-sectional view of the wafer surface.

(6) FIG. 4C is a third longitudinal cross-sectional view of the wafer surface.

(7) FIG. 5A is a first longitudinal cross-sectional view of the wafer surface related to a second embodiment step of the above method.

(8) FIG. 5B is a second longitudinal cross-sectional view of the wafer surface.

(9) FIG. 5C is a third longitudinal cross-sectional view of the wafer surface.

(10) FIG. 6 is a characteristic diagram illustrating a relationship between a film formation temperature and a film formation rate in forming a ruthenium layer.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) In a manufacturing process of semiconductor devices, there are steps of forming a recess on an insulating film by etching, and then embedding a wiring metal into the recess. With the miniaturization of semiconductor devices, ruthenium, which is a low-resistance material, has gained attention for use as an embedding metal. The present disclosure relates to a process of embedding ruthenium in a recess formed on a surface of a semiconductor wafer (hereinafter referred to as “wafer”), which serves as a substrate.

(12) <Film Forming Apparatus>

(13) Hereinafter, one embodiment of an apparatus for embedding ruthenium (Ru) into a recess formed on a wafer surface (hereinafter referred to as “film forming apparatus”) will be described with reference to FIGS. 1 and 2. FIG. 1 is a schematic plan view illustrating a configuration example of a film forming apparatus 1. This film forming apparatus 1 includes an atmospheric transfer chamber 11, a load lock chamber 12, first and second substrate transfer chambers 13 and 14, a plurality of preprocessors 15, and a plurality of Ru film formers 2.

(14) The first substrate transfer chamber 13 and the second substrate transfer chamber 14 each have a rectangular shape in a plan view, and are connected to each other via two delivery sections 17, for example. Interiors of the first and second substrate transfer chambers 13 and 14 and the delivery sections 17 are set to a vacuum pressure atmosphere, and the pressures of the interiors of the first and second substrate transfer chambers 13 and 14 and the delivery sections 17 are made to be equal. The delivery section 17 is configured to deliver a wafer between the delivery section 17 and a first transfer mechanism 131 provided in the first substrate transfer chamber 13 or between the delivery section 17 and a second transfer mechanism 141 provided in the second substrate transfer chamber 14.

(15) It is assumed that the direction in which these substrate transfer chambers 13 and 14 are arranged is the front-back direction, the first substrate transfer chamber 13 is at the front side, and the second vacuum transfer chamber 14 is at the rear side. The atmospheric transfer chamber 11, which is set to an atmospheric pressure atmosphere, is connected to the front side of the first substrate transfer chamber 13 via, for example, three load lock chambers 12. Wafer transfer openings and gate valves that open and close these transfer openings are provided respectively, between the first and second substrate transfer chambers 13 and 14 and the delivery sections 17, between the load lock chambers 12 and the first substrate transfer chamber 13, and between the load lock chambers 12 and the atmospheric transfer chamber 11, but these are omitted in the illustration.

(16) Load ports 101 (e.g., four load ports 101) are connected to the atmospheric transfer chamber 11, and a carrier C accommodating multiple sheets of wafers 10 is mounted on each load port 101. An atmospheric transfer mechanism 111 is provided in the atmospheric transfer chamber 11 and is capable of transferring the wafer 10 between the carriers C connected to the atmospheric transfer chamber 11 and the load lock chambers 12.

(17) When viewed from the front side, for example, two preprocessors 15 are connected to each of two walls (left wall and right wall) of the first substrate transfer chamber 13, respectively. The first transfer mechanism 131 provided in the first substrate transfer chamber 13 is then configured to transfer the wafer 10 between these four preprocessors 15, the delivery sections 17, and the load lock chambers 12. In FIG. 1, reference symbol GV1 denotes a gate valve.

(18) In this example, the preprocessors 15 include an etching processor 151 that performs a chemical oxide removal (COR) process, a heating processor 152 that performs a post heat treatment (PHT) process, and a Ti film formation processor 153 that performs a film formation process for a titanium (Ti) film that becomes a contact layer provided in the silicon wafer at the underlayer side. The COR process, PHT process, and Ti film formation process correspond to

preprocessing performed before embedding ruthenium into the recess on the wafer surface. The COR process and PHT process serve as pre-clean processing to remove a native oxide film (SiO₂) on the silicon wafer surface, which is formed on an inner surface of the recess.

(19) The etching processor **151** is configured to use, for example, a hydrogen fluoride (HF) gas and an ammonia (NH₃) gas and to perform an etching process (COR process) on the native oxide film. Further, the heating processor **152** is configured to perform a PHT process that sublimates and removes a reaction product generated during the COR process by heating the wafer **10**. This effectively removes the native oxide film. The Ti film formation processor **153** is configured to introduce a film forming gas for forming a Ti film into a processing container, thus forming a Ti film by a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) method.

(20) When viewed from the front side, for example, two sets of Ru film formers **2** are connected, respectively, to two walls (left and right walls) of the second substrate transfer chamber **14**. The second transfer mechanism **141** is then configured to transfer the wafer **10** between these four Ru film formers **2** and the delivery sections **17**. In FIG. **1**, reference symbols GV2 and GV3 denote gate valves, respectively. In this example, the second substrate transfer chamber **14** corresponds to a substrate transfer chamber of the present disclosure, and the second transfer mechanism **141** corresponds to a transfer mechanism of the present disclosure.

(21) Each set of the Ru film formers **2** includes, for example, a first film formation processor **2A** that forms a first ruthenium film (first Ru film) and a second film formation processor **2B** that forms a second ruthenium film (second Ru film). The first Ru film is a thin film of ruthenium that is formed in a region, including a bottom portion of the recess on the wafer surface, using a gas containing, as a ruthenium precursor, a ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms. Further, the second Ru film is a ruthenium film that is embedded in the recess to cover the ruthenium layer (first Ru film) using a gas containing, as a ruthenium precursor, Ru₃(CO)₁₂.

(22) <First Film Formation Processor>

(23) Next, a configuration example of the first film formation processor **2A** will be described with reference to FIG. **2**. The first film formation processor **2A** includes a first processing container **21**, and a lower portion of the first processing container **21** is configured as an exhaust chamber **211**. A sidewall of the first processing container **21** includes a transfer opening **20** connected to the second substrate transfer chamber **14** for loading and unloading the wafer **10** between the first processing container **21** and the second substrate transfer chamber **14**. The transfer opening **20** is configured to be opened and closed by the gate valve GV2. The exhaust chamber **211** is connected to a vacuum exhaust mechanism **25** via an exhaust pipe **23** provided with a pressure adjuster **24**.

(24) A susceptor **3** that horizontally supports the wafer **10** is provided inside the first processing container **21** in a state in which the susceptor **3** is supported by a support column **32** from a bottom surface of the susceptor **3**. The susceptor **3** includes a heater **31** and is configured to heat the wafer **10** to a preset temperature.

(25) A showerhead **4** is arranged on a ceiling portion of the first processing container **21** so as to face the wafer **10** mounted on the susceptor **3**. The showerhead **4** has a gas diffusion space **41**, and gas outlets **42** are formed and dispersed on a lower surface of the showerhead **4**.

(26) The first film formation processor **2A** includes a gas supply mechanism **5** including a first gas supplier. The first gas supplier is configured to supply a gas containing a ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen atom and carbon atom, for example, Ru(PF₃)₃.4H₂O, to the first processing container **21**. The gas supply mechanism **5** of this example includes a precursor container **51** that accommodates a film forming precursor **S1**, and is configured such that the film forming precursor **S1** inside the precursor container **51** is heated by a heater **52** provided on a sidewall of the precursor container **51**. The solid-phase Ru(PF₃)₃.4H₂O as the film forming precursor **S1** of the first Ru film is accommodated in the precursor container **51**.

(27) One end of a supply pipe **53** for a carrier gas is connected to the precursor container **51** so as

to be inserted into the film forming precursor S1. The other end of that supply pipe 53 is connected to a carrier gas source 531 via a valve V11, a mass flow controller M1, and a valve V12 in this order from the downstream side. The carrier gas may be an inert gas such as argon (Ar) gas or nitrogen (N.sub.2) gas. Further, an upper end surface of the precursor container 51 is connected to a gas inlet 43 of the showerhead 4 via a gas supply pipe 54, which has a valve V21, a flow meter 541, and a valve V22 in this order from the precursor container 51 side. The precursor container 51, the carrier gas source 531, the supply pipe 53 for the carrier gas, the gas supply pipe 54, and others constitute the first gas supplier of this example.

(28) Further, the gas inlet 43 of the showerhead 4 is connected to a reaction gas source 551 via a gas supply pipe 55, which has a valve V31, a mass flow controller M2, and a valve V32 in this order from the downstream side. In this example, a reducing gas such as a hydrogen (H.sub.2) gas is used as a reaction gas. Further, the reaction gas may also be a NH.sub.3 gas, H.sub.2 plasma, NH.sub.3 plasma, monomethylhydrazine (MMH), hydrazine (N.sub.2H.sub.4), etc., in addition to the H.sub.2 gas.

(29) <Second Film Formation Processor>

(30) Next, a configuration example of the second film formation processor 2B will be described with reference to FIG. 3. The second film formation processor 2B includes a second processing container 22. A sidewall of the second processing container 22 includes a transfer opening (not illustrated) connected to the second substrate transfer chamber 14 for loading and unloading the wafer 10 between the second processing container 22 and the second substrate transfer chamber 14. The transfer opening is configured to be able to be opened and closed by the gate valve GV3. In this example, other components inside the second processing container 22 have the same configuration as those inside the first processing container 21 as previously described above, and therefore, the description and illustration thereof are omitted. In addition, when referring to the components provided inside the second processing container 22 in the following description, there may be cases where reference numerals given to the components inside the first processing container 21 illustrated in FIG. 2 are also used.

(31) The second film formation processor 2B includes a gas supply mechanism 6 including a second gas supplier. The second gas supplier is configured to supply, for example, a gas containing Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 and a CO gas to the second processing container 22.

(32) The gas supply mechanism 6 in this example includes a precursor container 61 that accommodates a film forming precursor S2 and is configured to be heated by a heater 62 provided on a sidewall thereof. The solid-phase Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 as the film forming precursor S2 for the second Ru film is accommodated in the precursor container 61.

(33) One end of a supply pipe 63 for a carrier gas is connected to the precursor container 61 so as to be inserted into the film forming precursor S2. The other end of that supply pipe 63 is connected to a carrier gas source such as a CO gas source 651 via a valve V41, a mass flow controller M3, and a valve V42 in this order from the downstream side. However, the carrier gas may be an inert gas such as Ar gas or N.sub.2 gas, instead of a CO gas.

(34) An upper end surface of the precursor container 61 is connected to the gas inlet 43 of the showerhead 4 via a gas supply pipe 64, which has a valve V51, a flow meter 641, and a valve V52 in this order from the precursor container 61 side. Further, the gas supply pipe 64 is connected, at a position between the valve V52 and the gas inlet 43, to a reaction adjustment gas source such as a CO gas source 651 via a gas supply pipe 65, which has a valve V61, a mass flow controller M4, and a valve V62 in this order from the downstream side. The reaction adjustment gas may be a N.sub.2 gas, H.sub.2 gas, Ar gas, or the like, in addition to a CO gas.

(35) In the example illustrated in FIG. 3, the precursor container 61 of Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12, the carrier gas source 631, the supply pipe 63 of the carrier gas, the gas supply pipe 64, the CO gas source 651 for the reaction adjustment, the gas supply pipe 65, and others constitute the second gas supplier of this example.

(36) <Controller>

(37) The film forming apparatus **1** includes a controller **100** that controls the operation of each part that constitutes the film forming apparatus **1**, such as various processes in the preprocessors **15** and the Ru film formers **2** and wafer transfer. This controller **100** is formed of, for example, a computer having a CPU and a storage, although not illustrated. The storage stores a program containing a group of steps (commands) related to the control required to form the ruthenium layer (first Ru film) and the embedding ruthenium (second Ru film) as will be described later. This program is, for example, stored in a storage medium such as a hard disk, compact disk, magneto optical disk, memory card, or non-volatile memory, and is installed from the storage medium to the computer.

(38) <Surface Structure of Wafer>

(39) Here, an example of the surface structure of the wafer, which is a processing target for embedding of ruthenium, will be described with reference to FIG. **4A**. An insulating film, such as a silicon oxide film (SiO film) **73**, having a recess **72** is formed on a surface of a silicon wafer **71** serving as a substrate. A silicon nitride layer (SiN layer) **74** is formed on a sidewall portion **721** of this recess **72** so as to cover the SiO film **73**. Further, for example, a surface of a titanium silicide layer (TiSi layer) **75**, which is a metal layer containing titanium (Ti) and silicon (Si), is exposed at a bottom surface **722** of the recess **72**. The TiSi layer **75** functions as a contact layer to establish conduction with the silicon wafer **71**.

(40) As an example of the dimensions of the recess **72**, a width W is formed within a range of 5 nm to 20 nm, a depth D is formed within a range of 50 nm to 200 nm, and an aspect ratio (depth D /width W) is within a range of 2.5 to 40.

(41) This surface structure of the wafer is formed as follows, for example. First, after forming the SiO film **73** on the surface of the silicon wafer **71**, the recess **72** is formed by etching, and then the SiN layer **74** is formed to cover an inner surface of the recess **72**. Subsequently, the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72** is removed by anisotropic etching to form a region for TiSi layer. After this, the wafer is transferred to the film forming apparatus **1** to form a Ti film, resulting in the formation of the TiSi layer **75**.

First Embodiment

(42) Next, a first embodiment of a method for embedding ruthenium in the recess **72** formed on the wafer surface will be described along with the operations of the film forming apparatus **1**.

(43) In the film forming apparatus **1**, first, the wafer **10** accommodated in the carrier **C** is taken out by the atmospheric transfer mechanism **111** and is transferred to the load lock chamber **12** in an atmospheric pressure atmosphere. The load lock chamber **12** is then adjusted to a vacuum pressure atmosphere. Next, the wafer **10** inside the load lock chamber **12** is sequentially transferred to the etching processor **151** and the heating processor **152** by the first transfer mechanism **131**, and is subjected to pre-clean processing previously described above to remove a native oxide film formed on the inner surface of the recess **72**.

(44) Subsequently, the wafer **10** is transferred to the Ti film formation processor **153** by the first transfer mechanism **131**, and is subjected to formation of a Ti film on a region for TiSi layer. Once the Ti film has been formed, the TiSi layer **75** is formed by diffusing Si of the silicon wafer **71** into the Ti film. As a result, the surface of the TiSi layer **75** is exposed at the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72**. The wafer **10**, which has undergone these COR process, PHT process, and Ti film formation process, has the structure illustrated in FIG. **4A**, and ruthenium is embedded in the wafer **10**.

(45) <Formation of Ruthenium Layer (First Ru Film)>

(46) Subsequently, the wafer **10** is transferred to the first film formation processor **2A** via the first transfer mechanism **131**, the delivery sections **17**, and the second transfer mechanism **141**. The first film formation processor **2A** performs a process of forming a ruthenium layer in a region including the bottom portion of the recess **72**.

(47) Specifically, the wafer **10** is loaded into the first processing container **21** and is mounted on the

susceptor **3**. The wafer **10** is then heated, and the interior of the first processing container **21** is evacuated. As is clear from an evaluation test to be described later, the film formation rate of the first Ru film at the same film formation temperature varies depending on the type of reducing gas. (48) At this time, Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 is heated by the heater **52** in the precursor container **51**. A carrier gas is supplied to this precursor container **51**, causing Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 vaporized by heating to be picked up and supplied to the first processing container **21** as a ruthenium precursor.

(49) Further, a H.sub.2 gas serving as a reducing gas is supplied to the first processing container **21**, thus forming a first Ru film **81**, which is a ruthenium layer, in a region including the bottom portion of the recess **72** by CVD using the H.sub.2 gas and a Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 gas (FIG. **4B**). In this film formation process, Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 adsorbed onto the surface of the wafer **10** is reduced with the H.sub.2 gas, resulting in the formation of a ruthenium film.

(50) In the first embodiment, the ruthenium film (first Ru film **81**) is formed such that the thickness of the ruthenium film is greater on the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72** where the TiSi layer **75** is exposed than on the sidewall portion **721** of the recess **72** covered with the SiN layer **74**.

Therefore, in this example, the first Ru film **81** is formed under a condition where the film formation rate is greater on the bottom surface **722** side of the recess **72** than on the SiN layer **74** side (sidewall portion side). This condition may be realized by adjusting factors such as the heating temperature of the wafer **10**, the internal pressure of the processing container **21**, and the supply ratio of the ruthenium precursor to the reducing gas. This condition may be specified, for example, through preliminary experiments. In addition, the inventors have confirmed that the above-described configuration of the Ru film is obtained when using Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 for film formation.

(51) In this way, the first Ru film **81** is formed so as to be thicker on the bottom portion than on the sidewall portion **721** inside the recess **72**. In this example, the thickness of the first Ru film **81** formed on the bottom portion of the recess **72** is within a range of 1 nm to 5 nm, and is, for example, 2 nm. In addition, the bottom portion of the recess **72** refers to a region including the bottom surface **722**, which will be described in the second embodiment to be described later.

Further, the thickness of the first Ru film **81** formed on the sidewall portion **721** is sufficient to allow the subsequent embedding of ruthenium (formation of a second Ru film **82** into the recess **72**) without blocking the recess **72**. This film thickness varies depending on the width W and the aspect ratio of the recess **72**.

(52) In addition, the inventors are aware that the Ru film is hardly deposited on an exposed surface of the SiO film **73**. Therefore, if the SiN layer **74** covering the SiO film **73** is not formed on the sidewall portion **721** of the recess **72**, the above-described method results in little or no formation of the first Ru film **81** on the sidewall portion **721** even if film formation is performed. Here, FIGS. **4B** and **4C** illustrate an example where the Ru film is deposited on a top surface of the SiO film **73**, but there are cases where the Ru film is deposited on the top surface of the SiO film **73** depending on film formation conditions.

(53) The first Ru film **81** is formed using a gas containing a ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms, as a ruthenium precursor. Therefore, the first Ru film **81** does not contain oxygen atoms originating from a precursor, and there is less risk that the metal layer exposed at the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72** is oxidized. Further, there is less likelihood of residual carbon atoms originating from a precursor inside the first Ru film **81**. In contrast, if the ruthenium precursor is a ruthenium compound containing oxygen and carbon atoms, there is a higher risk that the formed Ru film will contain oxygen and carbon atoms. This may lead to the oxidation of the metal layer by oxygen atoms, resulting in the formation of a metal oxide and an increase in resistivity. Further, if the Ru film contains carbon atoms, it may contribute to an increase in resistivity and deterioration in film quality.

(54) As such, by using a ruthenium precursor that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms to

form the first Ru film **81**, an increase in resistivity at an interface with the TiSi layer **75** (contact layer), which is a metal layer exposed at the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72**, is prevented, and deterioration in film quality related to the conductivity of the first Ru film **81** is prevented.

(55) <Embedding of Ruthenium (Formation of Second Ru Film)>

(56) Subsequently, the second transfer mechanism **141** transfers the wafer **10**, on which the first Ru film **81** has been formed, to the second film formation processor **2B**. The second film formation processor **2B** performs a process of embedding ruthenium in the recess **72** to cover the ruthenium layer (first Ru film **81**) formed inside the recess **72**.

(57) Specifically, the wafer **10** is loaded into the second processing container **22** and is mounted on the susceptor **3**. The wafer **10** is then heated to a temperature lower than the film formation temperature of the first Ru film **81**, for example, within a range of 120 degrees C. to 300 degrees C. Further, the internal pressure of the second processing container **22** is regulated to, for example, 1.3 Pa. At this time, Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 is heated by the heater **62** in the precursor container **61**. A CO gas serving as a carrier gas is supplied to this precursor container **61**, causing Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 vaporized by heating to be picked up and supplied to the second processing container **22**, as a ruthenium precursor. Furthermore, a CO gas for reaction adjustment is supplied to the second processing container **22**.

(58) This results in the vaporized Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 being supplied to the wafer **10**. Then, thermal CVD proceeds on the wafer **10** to thermally decompose Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12. The second Ru film **82** is formed on the SiO film **73** to have a preset thickness. During this film formation, the second Ru film **82** is formed to be embedded in the recess **72**, as illustrated in FIG. **4C**. In addition, the CO gas for reaction adjustment is supplied to prevent excessive progress of thermal decomposition. As such, the second Ru film **82** is formed to cover the first Ru film **81**, thereby being embedded inside the recess **72**.

(59) Here, as previously described above, the first Ru film **81** is formed not only on the bottom surface **722** but also on the sidewall portion **721** inside the recess **72**. The first Ru film **81** functions as a liner film that is an adhesion layer for the second Ru film **82**. Therefore, the deposition of the second Ru film **82** similarly proceeds on the sidewall portion **721** and bottom surface **722** side of the recess **72**, which facilitate rapid embedding of ruthenium into the recess **72**.

(60) The ruthenium precursor for the second Ru film **82** such as Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 contains oxygen and carbon atoms, but has no risk of oxidizing the TiSi layer **75** on the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72** when the second Ru film **82** is formed as a bulk film on top of the first Ru film **81**. Further, the inventors are aware that the upper limit of the resistivity of the bulk film formed using Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 is approximately 20 $\mu\Omega\cdot\text{cm}$ and the upper limit of the resistivity of the bulk film formed using Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 is approximately 100 $\mu\Omega\cdot\text{cm}$. Thus, in a region where there is no concern about the oxidation of the TiSi layer **75**, using Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 to form the second Ru film **82** may reduce the overall resistivity of ruthenium embedded in the recess **72**.

(61) After the film formation process is completed, the wafer **10** is transferred to the load lock chamber **12** via the second transfer mechanism **141**, the delivery sections **17**, and the first transfer mechanism **131**. Next, after the atmosphere in the load lock chamber **12** is switched to the atmospheric pressure atmosphere, the processed wafer **10** is returned to the carrier C by the atmospheric transfer mechanism **111**.

(62) Thereafter, the wafer **10** is transferred to a chemical mechanical polishing (CMP) apparatus provided outside the film forming apparatus **1** so that the surface of the wafer **10** is polished to remove the second Ru film **82** on the top surface of the recess **72** and an upper portion of the SiO film **73** constituting the recess **72**. Accordingly, the depth of the recess **72** after CMP becomes smaller than the above-described dimension.

(63) According to the above-described embodiment, it is possible to implement the embedding of ruthenium while preventing an increase in resistivity for the recess **72** formed on the wafer surface.

(64) To embed ruthenium into the deep recess **72** with a high aspect ratio, it is necessary for a bulk film serving as the embedding material to have low resistivity and to reduce the resistivity at the interface with the exposed metal layer (TiSi layer **75** in this example) on the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72**. As previously described above, the Ru film formed using Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 as a bulk film has low resistivity but contains oxygen atoms. Thus, embedding Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 in the recess **72** may lead to the formation of an oxide film at the interface with the metal layer, causing concerns about an increase in resistivity at that interface. On the other hand, since the Ru film formed using Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 does not contain oxygen atoms, an increase in resistivity at the interface is prevented, while the resistivity as a bulk film is higher than in the Ru film formed using Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 as previously described above.

(65) Therefore, two types of ruthenium precursors are combined, and the precursor of the first Ru film **81** formed at the interface with the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72** and the precursor of the second Ru film **82** as a bulk film are switched. Thus, the resistivity at the interface of the exposed metal on the bottom surface of the recess **72** may be lowered and a material with low resistivity may be selected as a bulk film, which enables the embedding of low-resistance ruthenium in the recess. As a result, it is possible to realize metal wiring with low resistivity.

(66) Further, when the sidewall portion **721** of the recess **72** is composed of the SiN layer **74**, the first Ru film **81** also functions as a liner film as previously described above. Therefore, the second Ru film **82** is rapidly formed in the recess **72**, and the film formation time of the second Ru film **82** is shortened, compared to a case where the first Ru film **81** is not formed on the sidewall portion **721** of the recess **72**.

(67) As such, when the sidewall portion **721** of the recess **72** is composed of the SiN layer **74**, there is no need to form a separate liner film, and the ruthenium embedded in the recess **72** includes two layers of the first Ru film **81** and the second Ru film **82**. Thus, since it is not necessary to form a separate liner film, there is no concern about an increase in the total effort or time for the process of embedding ruthenium in the recess **72** even when both films are formed by switching the ruthenium precursor gases.

(68) Further, in the above-described film forming apparatus **1**, the removal of the native oxide film in the recess **72**, the formation of the TiSi layer, the formation of the first Ru film **81**, and the formation of the second Ru film **82** are all performed inside the same film forming apparatus **1**. Since the processors for performing these processes are connected to the substrate transfer chamber in a vacuum pressure atmosphere, there is less risk of the native oxide film being formed in the recess due to contact between the wafer and the atmosphere during the transfer of the wafer between the processors. This allows for the rapid formation of low resistivity ruthenium in the recess **72** after the removal of the native oxide film.

Second Embodiment

(69) Next, a second embodiment of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. 5A to 5C. The second embodiment differs from the first embodiment in the film formation conditions of the first Ru film. Thus, the procedure up to the formation of the TiSi layer **75** exposed on the bottom surface of the recess **72** as illustrated in FIG. 5A is the same as in the first embodiment.

(70) In this embodiment as well, the wafer **10** is transferred to the first processing container **21** of the first film formation processor **4A**, and a gas containing a ruthenium precursor such as Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 and a reducing gas such as a H.sub.2 gas are supplied to form a first Ru film (ruthenium layer) **83** on the wafer by CVD.

(71) In the second embodiment, a ruthenium film (first Ru film **83**) is formed such that the thickness of the ruthenium film is uniform both on the sidewall portion **721** of the recess **72** covered with the SiN layer **74** and on the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72** where the TiSi layer **75** is exposed.

(72) In other words, in this embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. 5B, a substantially uniform thickness

of the first Ru film **83** is formed, which includes a Ru layer **831** on the sidewall portion **721** side and a Ru layer **832** on the bottom portion. The thickness of the first Ru film **83** formed in this example is within a range of 0.5 nm to 5 nm, and is, for example, 1 nm.

(73) Similarly to the film formation method in which the film thickness is greater on the bottom portion than on the sidewall portion **721** as described with reference to FIG. **4B**, the film formation of the first Ru film **83** in this embodiment may also be implemented by adjusting factors such as the heating temperature of the wafer **10**, the internal pressure of the processing container **21**, and the supply ratio between the ruthenium precursor and the reducing gas.

(74) In addition, in the film formation using Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 as a precursor, it is possible to form Ru films with different thicknesses, similarly to the example illustrated in FIG. **4B**, by lowering the film formation pressure and reducing the CO supply ratio. On the other hand, the inventors are aware that increasing the film formation pressure may result in the formation of a Ru film having a uniform thickness, similarly to the example illustrated in FIG. **5B**.

(75) The bottom portion of the recess **72** is a region where the first Ru film **83** is formed on the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72**. If the thickness of the first Ru film **83** is too small, oxygen atoms contained in the second Ru film **82** formed on top of the first Ru film **83** may diffuse to the TiSi layer **75**, causing concerns about an increase in resistivity. Further, if the thickness of the first Ru film **83** is too large, the region occupied by the second Ru film **82** becomes small, causing concerns about an increase in resistivity.

(76) Therefore, the thickness of the first Ru film **83** may be thicker than 1 nm.

(77) Further, “uniform thickness” refers to a ratio between a thickness T1 of the Ru layer **831** on the sidewall portion **721** of the recess **72** and a thickness T2 of the Ru layer **832** on the bottom portion of the recess **72** that is within a range of 0.8 to 1.2.

(78) After forming the first Ru film **83** in this way, the wafer **10** is transferred to the second film formation processor **2B**. Then, in the second processing container **22**, a process of embedding the second Ru film **82** into the recess **72** is performed so that the second Ru film **82** covers the first Ru film **83** by the same method as in the first embodiment. As such, in the next step, the wafer **10** with ruthenium embedded in the recess **72** is subjected to CMP, similarly to the first embodiment.

(79) In this embodiment as well, the first Ru film **83**, which originates from a precursor that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms, is formed at the interface between the TiSi layer **75** and the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72**. Then, the second Ru film **83** is formed as a bulk film using Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 to cover this first Ru film **83**. Therefore, ruthenium may be embedded in the recess **72** while preventing an increase in resistance.

(80) Further, in this embodiment, the first Ru film **83** is formed to have a substantially uniform thickness on the sidewall portion **721** and the bottom surface **722** of the recess **72**, and serves as a liner film. Therefore, the step of separately forming a liner film between the first Ru film **83** and the second Ru film **82** may be omitted.

(81) <Evaluation Test>

(82) Subsequently, an evaluation test of a ruthenium layer using a ruthenium precursor such as Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 will be described with reference to FIG. **6**. The ruthenium layer was formed within the range of the film formation conditions described in the first embodiment by changing the film formation temperature and the types of reaction gases (H.sub.2 gas and NH.sub.3 gas), and the film formation rate at this time was measured. In addition, the internal pressure of the processing container during film formation was set to 933 Pa. This result is illustrated in FIG. **6**.

(83) In FIG. **6**, the horizontal axis represents a reciprocal of the absolute temperature (T) multiplied by 1,000, with the smaller value indicating the higher film formation temperature. The numerical values on the horizontal axis, such as “1.6”, correspond to the temperatures of 352 degrees C., “1.7” to 315 degrees C., “1.8” to 283 degrees C., and “1.9” to 253 degrees C. Further, the vertical axis represents the natural logarithm of the film formation rate DR (nm/mm). Data for using a H.sub.2 gas as the reaction gas are plotted with filled black circles (.circle-solid.), while data for

using a NH.sub.3 gas are plotted with filled black squares (.square-solid.).

(84) According to the result of the film formation experiment, it was observed that a gas containing Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2 could form a ruthenium layer by CVD using either a H.sub.2 gas or NH.sub.3 gas as the reaction gas. Further, it was confirmed that the film formation rate varies by varying the film formation temperature, and that the film formation rate increases with higher film formation temperature in cases of any reaction gas. Furthermore, it was confirmed that the film formation rate varies depending on the type of reaction gas even at the same film formation temperature, and that the rate of change in film formation rate is different depending on a change in film formation temperature. Accordingly, it is understood that the optimal range of the film formation temperature may vary depending on the type of reaction gas even with the same ruthenium precursor.

(85) In each embodiment described above, the second gas supplier may be configured to supply a gas containing Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 to the processing container, and it is not essential to supply a CO gas for reaction adjustment.

(86) Further, the ruthenium precursor for forming the ruthenium layer may be any ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms, and is not limited to Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2. Furthermore, the method for forming the ruthenium layer may be not only CVD but also atomic layer deposition (ALD), where a precursor gas and a reaction gas are alternately supplied. Further, when performing CVD or ALD, a plasma may be used for activating the precursor gas or the reaction gas.

(87) Further, as illustrated in FIG. 1, it is not an essential requirement to form the first Ru films **81** and **83**, and the second Ru film **82** in different processing containers **21** and **22** of the first and second film formation processors **2A** and **2B**. For example, the film forming apparatus may be configured to perform the formation of a ruthenium layer (first Ru film **81** or **83**) and the embedding of ruthenium (second Ru film **82**) in a common processing container. In this case, the processing container is configured to include a first gas supplier that supplies a gas containing a ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms and a second gas supplier that supplies a gas containing Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12. Then, the first gas supplier supplies the gas containing the ruthenium compound to form a ruthenium layer on a region of the wafer **10** including the bottom portion of the recess **72**. Next, the gas supply is switched from the first gas supplier to the second gas supplier, such that a gas containing Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 is supplied to the wafer **10** to embed ruthenium into the recess **72** so as to cover the ruthenium layer.

(88) In the film forming apparatus **1** illustrated in FIG. 1, the delivery section **17** is used to connect two substrate transfer chambers **13** and **14**, but this is done to suppress enlarging the substrate transfer chamber when the number of modules connected to one substrate transfer chamber increases. Thus, if the enlargement of the substrate transfer chamber is suppressed, the preprocessor **15** and the Ru film former **2** may be connected to a common substrate transfer chamber. Further, contrary to this, the film forming apparatus **1** may be configured to include three or more substrate transfer chambers.

(89) The embodiments disclosed herein should be considered to be exemplary and not limitative in all respects. The above embodiments may be omitted, replaced or modified in various embodiments without departing from the scope of the appended claims and their gist.

EXPLANATION OF REFERENCE NUMERALS

(90) **10**: semiconductor wafer, **72**: recess, **81**, **83**: first ruthenium film (ruthenium layer), **82**: second ruthenium film (embedded ruthenium film)

Claims

1. A method for embedding ruthenium in a recess formed on a surface of a substrate, the method comprising: forming a ruthenium layer in a region including a bottom portion of the recess by

- supplying a first gas including, as a first ruthenium precursor, a ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms to the substrate having a metal exposed on a bottom surface of the recess; and subsequently embedding ruthenium in the recess so as to cover the ruthenium layer by supplying a second gas including, as a second ruthenium precursor, Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 to the substrate.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the ruthenium compound is Ru(PF.sub.3).sub.4H.sub.2.
 3. The method of claim 2, wherein the second gas including Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 further includes a CO gas.
 4. The method of claim 3, wherein in the forming the ruthenium layer, the ruthenium layer is formed such that the ruthenium layer formed on the bottom portion of the recess is thicker than the ruthenium layer formed along a sidewall portion of the recess.
 5. The method of claim 4, wherein the recess is formed in a silicon oxide film on the surface of the substrate, and wherein the metal exposed on the bottom surface of the recess includes titanium and silicon.
 6. The method of claim 5, wherein a silicon nitride layer covering the silicon oxide film is formed on the sidewall portion of the recess.
 7. The method of claim 3, wherein in the forming the ruthenium layer, the ruthenium layer is formed to have a uniform thickness between the ruthenium layer formed on a sidewall portion of the recess and the ruthenium layer formed on the bottom portion of the recess.
 8. The method of claim 7, wherein the recess is formed in a silicon oxide film on the surface of the substrate, and wherein the metal exposed on the bottom surface of the recess includes titanium and silicon.
 9. The method of claim 8, wherein a silicon nitride layer covering the silicon oxide film is formed on the sidewall portion of the recess.
 10. The method of claim 1, wherein the second gas including Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 further includes a CO gas.
 11. The method of claim 1, wherein in the forming the ruthenium layer, the ruthenium layer is formed such that the ruthenium layer formed on the bottom portion of the recess is thicker than the ruthenium layer formed along a sidewall portion of the recess.
 12. The method of claim 1, wherein in the forming the ruthenium layer, the ruthenium layer is formed to have a uniform thickness between the ruthenium layer formed on a sidewall portion of the recess and the ruthenium layer formed on the bottom portion of the recess.
 13. An apparatus for embedding ruthenium in a recess formed on a surface of a substrate, the apparatus comprising: a processing container configured to accommodate the substrate having a metal exposed on a bottom surface of the recess; a first gas supplier configured to supply a first gas including, as a first ruthenium precursor, a ruthenium compound that does not contain oxygen and carbon atoms to the processing container; a second gas supplier configured to supply a second gas including, as a second ruthenium precursor, Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 to the processing container; and a controller, wherein the controller is configured to output control signals for executing: a step of forming a ruthenium layer in a region including a bottom portion of the recess by supplying the first gas including the ruthenium compound from the first gas supplier to the substrate inside the processing container; and a step of subsequently embedding ruthenium in the recess so as to cover the ruthenium layer by supplying the second gas including Ru.sub.3(CO).sub.12 from the second gas supplier to the substrate.
 14. The apparatus of claim 13, wherein the processing container includes a first processing container provided with the first gas supplier and a second processing container provided with the second gas supplier, the first processing container and the second processing container being configured as separate bodies, wherein the first processing container and the second processing container are connected to a common substrate transfer chamber including a transfer mechanism for the substrate, and wherein the controller is further configured to output control signals for

executing: the step of forming the ruthenium layer in the first processing container, and then a step of transferring the substrate having the ruthenium layer formed on the substrate to the second processing container and embedding the ruthenium in the second processing container.

15. The apparatus of claim 13, wherein the first gas supplier is configured to supply, as the ruthenium compound, $\text{Ru}(\text{PF}_3)_4\text{H}_2$.

16. The apparatus of claim 13, wherein the second gas supplier is further configured to supply a gas including $\text{Ru}_3(\text{CO})_{12}$ and a CO gas.

17. The apparatus of claim 13, wherein in the forming the ruthenium layer, the ruthenium layer is formed such that the ruthenium layer formed on the bottom portion of the recess is thicker than the ruthenium layer formed along a sidewall portion of the recess.

18. The apparatus of claim 13, wherein in the forming the ruthenium layer, the ruthenium layer is formed to have a uniform thickness between the ruthenium layer formed on a sidewall portion of the recess and the ruthenium layer formed on the bottom portion of the recess.

19. The apparatus of claim 13, wherein the recess is formed in a silicon oxide film on the surface of the substrate, and wherein the metal exposed on the bottom surface of the recess includes titanium and silicon.

20. The apparatus of claim 19, wherein a silicon nitride layer covering the silicon oxide film is formed on a sidewall portion of the recess.
